# SSC CHSL 2020 Tier-I question paper with answers

**9 August 2021 · Shift 1**

65 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 35 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20211105175401/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerKeys_%20CHSLE2020_05112021.pdf

## English Language 24 questions

**Q.1**

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice. Aditya passed the driving test quite easily.

**(A)** The driving test had passed quite easily by Aditya.
**(B)** The driving test have been passed quite easily by Aditya.
**(C)** The driving test could passed quite easily by Aditya.
**(D)** The driving test was passed quite easily by Aditya.

**Q.2**

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. To cut corners

**(A)** cut something easily without spoiling it
**(B)** cut something into pieces
**(C)** be able to do a job effortlessly
**(D)** not do a thing well in order to save money or effort

**Q.3**

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Cook the books

**(A)** To falsify financial records
**(B)** To be a good writer
**(C)** To write books on cooking
**(D)** To be a good editor

**Q.4**

In the given sentence, identify the segment which contains a grammatical error. Doctors say that home isolation is far more effective than hospitalise in cases of mild infection.

**(A)** far more effective
**(B)** than hospitalise
**(C)** isolation is
**(D)** Doctors say that

**Q.5**

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. "Sometimes the family liking" to play a game together after dinner.

**(A)** Sometimes the family likes
**(B)** Sometime the family likes
**(C)** No substitution required
**(D)** Sometimes the family are like

**Q.6**

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. Have you thought about the _____ of the recent decision you took?

**(A)** conclusions
**(B)** complexes
**(C)** consequences
**(D)** concerns

**Q.7**

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Out of the given options, select the one that gives their correct order. A. On either side of the trunk there are a few scattered tufts of short grass. B. It is towards one of these fallen trees that I am now looking. C. A very violent cyclonic storm has struck the forest, uprooting a number of trees. D. The trunk of the tree is ripped apart and the branches are lying all around it.

**(A)** ABDC
**(B)** ADBC
**(C)** CBDA
**(D)** CDAB

**Q.8**

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Paranoid

**(A)** Impeccable
**(B)** Suspicious
**(C)** Insignificant
**(D)** Patronising

**Q.9**

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

**(A)** Endurance
**(B)** Tolerance
**(C)** Insistence
**(D)** Persistance

**Q.10**

Select the word which means the same as the group of words given. One who has the power to do anything

**(A)** omnipresent
**(B)** multifaceted
**(C)** omnipotent
**(D)** multilingual

**Q.11**

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. The headmaster _____ on the stage and gave a short speech.

**(A)** prescribed
**(B)** appeared
**(C)** delighted
**(D)** remembered

**Q.12**

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. BRAVERY

**(A)** heroism
**(B)** strength
**(C)** cowardice
**(D)** courage

**Q.13**

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. ABSOLUTE

**(A)** limited
**(B)** complete
**(C)** partial
**(D)** conditional

**Q.14**

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Clandestine

**(A)** Heavy
**(B)** Honest
**(C)** Dressed
**(D)** Opaque

**Q.15**

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A person who presents a radio/television programme

**(A)** Idol
**(B)** Anchor
**(C)** Speaker
**(D)** Star

**Q.16**

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution'. "Had you not interfering" in my affairs, I would have been in the US now.

**(A)** No substitution
**(B)** Had you not interfered
**(C)** Was you not interfere
**(D)** Have you not been interfering

**Q.17**

Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the right order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph. A. His father shifted his own ambitions to those of his son, providing him with models and support for his first exhibition at the age of 13. B. Pablo Picasso was the son of José Ruiz Blasco, a professor of drawing, and Maria Picasso López. C. From that point his ability to experiment with what he learned and to develop new expressive means quickly allowed him to surpass his father's abilities. D. His unusual adeptness for drawing began to manifest itself early, around the age of 10, when he became his father's pupil.

**(A)** BDCA
**(B)** DCAB
**(C)** BADC
**(D)** CDAB

**Q.18**

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. The need today is for both sides / to introspect and re-examine the issue carefully / and resolve it amicably.

**(A)** to introspect and re-examine the issue carefully
**(B)** and resolve it amicably
**(C)** No error
**(D)** The need today is for both sides

**Q.20**

Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence. My niece said, "I have decided to take coaching in badminton."

**(A)** My niece told me that she had decided to take coaching in badminton.
**(B)** My niece told that I have decided to take coaching in badminton.
**(C)** My niece said she is deciding to take coaching in badminton.
**(D)** My niece said she will decide to take coaching in badminton.

**Q.21**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Kanjirapally has the highest number of rainy days in Kerala. It receives the highest (1)_____ of summer rains, winter rains and northeast monsoons in Kerala, (2)_____ it one of the very few (3)_____ in India enjoying equatorial rainforest type climate, with no (4) _____ dry season. The well-distributed rainfall pattern of Kanjirapally is the (5)_____ reason for the phenomenon of high yield of latex from rubber plantations in and around the town.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.1.

**(A)** amount
**(B)** number
**(C)** expanse
**(D)** extent

**Q.22**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Kanjirapally has the highest number of rainy days in Kerala. It receives the highest (1)_____ of summer rains, winter rains and northeast monsoons in Kerala, (2)_____ it one of the very few (3)_____ in India enjoying equatorial rainforest type climate, with no (4) _____ dry season. The well-distributed rainfall pattern of Kanjirapally is the (5)_____ reason for the phenomenon of high yield of latex from rubber plantations in and around the town.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.2.

**(A)** make
**(B)** making
**(C)** made
**(D)** makes

**Q.23**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Kanjirapally has the highest number of rainy days in Kerala. It receives the highest (1)_____ of summer rains, winter rains and northeast monsoons in Kerala, (2)_____ it one of the very few (3)_____ in India enjoying equatorial rainforest type climate, with no (4) _____ dry season. The well-distributed rainfall pattern of Kanjirapally is the (5)_____ reason for the phenomenon of high yield of latex from rubber plantations in and around the town.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.3.

**(A)** space
**(B)** places
**(C)** spot
**(D)** place

**Q.24**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Kanjirapally has the highest number of rainy days in Kerala. It receives the highest (1)_____ of summer rains, winter rains and northeast monsoons in Kerala, (2)_____ it one of the very few (3)_____ in India enjoying equatorial rainforest type climate, with no (4) _____ dry season. The well-distributed rainfall pattern of Kanjirapally is the (5)_____ reason for the phenomenon of high yield of latex from rubber plantations in and around the town.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.4.

**(A)** individual
**(B)** divergent
**(C)** diverse
**(D)** distinct

**Q.25**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Kanjirapally has the highest number of rainy days in Kerala. It receives the highest (1)_____ of summer rains, winter rains and northeast monsoons in Kerala, (2)_____ it one of the very few (3)_____ in India enjoying equatorial rainforest type climate, with no (4) _____ dry season. The well-distributed rainfall pattern of Kanjirapally is the (5)_____ reason for the phenomenon of high yield of latex from rubber plantations in and around the town.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.5.

**(A)** insignificant
**(B)** primary
**(C)** minor
**(D)** initial

## General Intelligence 18 questions

**Q.1**

Select the option in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following set. 28 : 50 : 94

**(A)** 22 : 37 : 67

**(B)** 41 : 77 : 149

**(C)** 19 : 40 : 82

**(D)** 36 : 66 : 126

**Q.2**

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 8, 8, 11, 11, 14, 14, ?

**(A)** 22

**(B)** 14

**(C)** 18

**(D)** 17

**Q.4**

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All rats are cats. Some cats are not dogs. Conclusions: I. Some dogs are not rats. II. Some dogs are rats.

**(A)** Both conclusions I and II follow.

**(B)** Only conclusion II follows.

**(C)** Only conclusion I follows.

**(D)** Neither conclusion I nor II follows.

**Q.5**

Select the word-pair in which the two words are related in the same way as are the two words in the given word-pair. Mathematics : Teacher

**(A)** Hockey : Coach

**(B)** Science : Researcher

**(C)** Student : Tutor

**(D)** Story : Book

**Q.7**

Select the combination of letters that when sequentially placed in the blanks of the given series will complete the series. s _ t m s r _ m _ r t _ s _ t m

**(A)** r, t, s, m, r

**(B)** r, t, r, m, s

**(C)** r, s, m, r, t

**(D)** r, s, t, r, m

**Q.9**

Four words have been given, out of which three are alike in some manner and one is different. Select the word that is different.

**(A)** Steel

**(B)** Brass

**(C)** Nickel

**(D)** Bronze

**Q.10**

The cost of 5 pens and 12 pencils is ₹45. What would be the cost for 20 pens and 48 pencils?

**(A)** ₹180

**(B)** ₹210

**(C)** ₹135

**(D)** ₹235

**Q.11**

Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following set. (313, 2732, 98211)

**(A)** (103, 7341, 92501)

**(B)** (601, 9401, 71427)

**(C)** (201, 4532, 65712)

**(D)** (301, 6543, 94263)

**Q.12**

Which of the following numbers does NOT belong to the group? 423, 171, 801, 900, 701

**(A)** 171
**(B)** 701
**(C)** 801
**(D)** 423

**Q.14**

Three of the following four letter-clusters are alike in a certain way and one is different. Select the odd one.

**(A)** YTSR
**(B)** AEKM
**(C)** IMPV
**(D)** JMSU

**Q.15**

Select the option that is related to the third number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number. 166 : 415 : : 256 : ?

**(A)** 640
**(B)** 549
**(C)** 428
**(D)** 597

**Q.17**

M's wife is N's daughter-in-law. P is the husband of O, who is the sister of M. How is P related to N?

**(A)** Brother
**(B)** Cousin
**(C)** Nephew
**(D)** Son-in-law

**Q.18**

If in a code language, ORGAN is coded as 17141518 and FINGER is coded as 56791418, then how will you code NECK?

**(A)** 113497
**(B)** 248741
**(C)** 351114
**(D)** 532761

**Q.19**

In a certain code language, HUSBAND is written as ABDHNSU. How will HOUSEWIFE be written in that language?

**(A)** EFIWESUOH
**(B)** EHEFOIUWS
**(C)** EEFHIOSUW
**(D)** ESEFUOIWH

**Q.21**

Which two digits and signs need to be interchanged so as to balance the given equation? 75 – 13 + 19 × 8 ÷ 5 = 93

**(A)** 7 and 9; + and ×
**(B)** 5 and 8; – and ÷
**(C)** 3 and 5; – and ×
**(D)** 8 and 3; × and ÷

**Q.22**

Select the option that is related to the third term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term. SHORTLY : OHSYLTR : : WALKING : ?

**(A)** LAWNIKG
**(B)** KLAWGNI
**(C)** AWKLNIG
**(D)** LAWGNIK

**Q.23**

Select the option that is related to the third word in the same way as the second word is related to the first word. Wakeful : Sleepless : : Sitting : ?

**(A)** Idle Resting
**(B)** Situated
**(C)** Sedentary
**(D)** Steadily

**Q.24**

Arrange the following words in a meaningful sequence. 1. Manager 2. Worker 3. General manager 4. Supervisor 5. Owner

**(A)** 3, 5, 4, 1, 2
**(B)** 1, 3, 5, 2, 4
**(C)** 4, 3, 2, 1, 5
**(D)** 5, 3, 1, 4, 2

## General Awareness 23 questions

**Q.1**

In which year did Gongsa Ugyen Wangchuck become the first monarch of Bhutan?

**(A)** 1901
**(B)** 1910
**(C)** 1905
**(D)** 1907

**Q.2**

Who among the following is the youngest test debutant in the history of cricket as on May 2020?

**(A)** Mushtaq Mohammad
**(B)** Danish Kaneria
**(C)** Hasan Raza
**(D)** Mohammad Sharif

**Q.3**

Which of the following state governments approved the Freedom of Religion Bill 2020 in December 2020?

**(A)** Telangana
**(B)** Rajasthan
**(C)** Madhya Pradesh
**(D)** Uttar Pradesh

**Q.4**

Bangladesh was a part of Pakistan from _____.

**(A)** 1947 - 1973
**(B)** 1948 - 1975
**(C)** 1948 - 1979
**(D)** 1947 - 1971

**Q.5**

Which of the following is a pass on the Pir Panjal Range?

**(A)** Fotu La
**(B)** Zoji La
**(C)** Banihal
**(D)** Khardung La

**Q.6**

Which of the following is a primary storage device in a personal computer?

**(A)** Hard disk
**(B)** Compact disk
**(C)** Pen drive
**(D)** Random-access memory

**Q.8**

In which Olympic Games did Shabana Akhtar, the first female athlete to represent Pakistan, participate?

**(A)** Beijing Olympics
**(B)** Atlanta Olympics
**(C)** Sydney Olympics
**(D)** Barcelona Olympics

**Q.9**

In which of the following years did the Santhal Revolt take place?

**(A)** 1848-49
**(B)** 1874-75
**(C)** 1825-26
**(D)** 1855-56

**Q.10**
Which Indian Cabinet Minister was appointed as Executive Board Chairman of World Health Organization (WHO) in May 2020?

**(A)** Smriti Irani
**(B)** Nirmala Sitharaman
**(C)** Piyush Goyal
**(D)** Harsh Vardhan

**Q.11**
Who among the following boxers won a gold medal in the 57 kg category at the Cologne Boxing World Cup held at Germany in December 2020?

**(A)** Simranjit Kaur Baath
**(B)** Pooja Rani
**(C)** Sakshi Choudhary
**(D)** Manisha Moun

**Q.12**
'Puanchei' is the traditional dress of _____.

**(A)** Karnataka
**(B)** Mizoram
**(C)** Goa
**(D)** Sikkim

**Q.13**
The concept of fiscal policy is based fundamentally on the ideas of _____.

**(A)** Warren Buffett
**(B)** Elinor Ostrom
**(C)** John Maynard Keynes
**(D)** Milton Friedman

**Q.14**
What is the currency of Myanmar?

**(A)** Myanmar Riel
**(B)** Myanmar Dong
**(C)** Myanmar Kyat
**(D)** Myanmar Ringgit

**Q.15**
Due to which of the following reactions are household bleaching agents using phosphorous, sulphur and chlorine formed?

**(A)** Decomposition reaction
**(B)** Displacement reaction
**(C)** Combination reaction
**(D)** Disproportionation reaction

**Q.17**
A major portion of 'Sufed Koh' mountain range lies in _____.

**(A)** Pakistan
**(B)** China
**(C)** India
**(D)** Myanmar

**Q.18**
Which natural port is located along the west coast of India?

**(A)** Visakhapatnam
**(B)** Haldia
**(C)** Chennai
**(D)** Marmagao

**Q.19**
Which day in May 2020 was observed as 'International Tea Day'?

**(A)** 21 May
**(B)** 1 May
**(C)** 15 May
**(D)** 23 May

**Q.20**
Which of the following is a polar molecule?

**(A)** Carbon tetrachloride
**(B)** Carbon dioxide
**(C)** Benzene
**(D)** Water

**Q.21**

Which one of the following features is NOT shown by metals?

**(A)** Looks dull
**(B)** Can be pounded into shape
**(C)** Can be made into a wire
**(D)** Conducts heat

**Q.22**

Who authored the book 'Jinnah: His Successes, Failures and Role in History'?

**(A)** Khushwant Singh
**(B)** Intizar Husain
**(C)** Ishtiaq Ahmed
**(D)** Ishrat Husain

**Q.23**

To which of the following Gharanas did the Hindustani classical vocalist Ustad Bade Ghulam Ali Khan belong?

**(A)** Patiala Gharana
**(B)** Jaipur-Atrauli Gharana
**(C)** Kirana Gharana
**(D)** Gwalior Gharana

**Q.24**

Which one of the following is a computer virus?

**(A)** Penguin
**(B)** Panda
**(C)** Spider
**(D)** Creeper

**Q.25**

Which was the first part of India to hold an election based on universal adult franchise?

**(A)** Assam
**(B)** Tripura
**(C)** Manipur
**(D)** Bihar

# Answer key

### English Language

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Q.1 **(D)** | Q.2 **(D)** | Q.3 **(A)** | Q.4 **(B)** | Q.5 **(A)** | Q.6 **(C)** |
| Q.7 **(C)** | Q.8 **(B)** | Q.9 **(D)** | Q.10 **(C)** | Q.11 **(B)** | Q.12 **(C)** |
| Q.13 **(B)** | Q.14 **(B)** | Q.15 **(B)** | Q.16 **(B)** | Q.17 **(A)** | Q.18 **(C)** |
| Q.20 **(A)** | Q.21 **(A)** | Q.22 **(B)** | Q.23 **(B)** | Q.24 **(D)** | Q.25 **(B)** |

### General Intelligence

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Q.1 **(D)** | Q.2 **(D)** | Q.4 **(D)** | Q.5 **(A)** | Q.7 **(A)** | Q.9 **(C)** |
| Q.10 **(A)** | Q.11 **(B)** | Q.12 **(B)** | Q.14 **(A)** | Q.15 **(A)** | Q.17 **(D)** |
| Q.18 **(C)** | Q.19 **(C)** | Q.21 **(B)** | Q.22 **(D)** | Q.23 **(C)** | Q.24 **(D)** |

### General Awareness

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Q.1 **(D)** | Q.2 **(C)** | Q.3 **(C)** | Q.4 **(D)** | Q.5 **(C)** | Q.6 **(D)** |
| Q.8 **(B)** | Q.9 **(D)** | Q.10 **(D)** | Q.11 **(D)** | Q.12 **(B)** | Q.13 **(C)** |
| Q.14 **(C)** | Q.15 **(D)** | Q.17 **(A)** | Q.18 **(D)** | Q.19 **(A)** | Q.20 **(D)** |
| Q.21 **(A)** | Q.22 **(C)** | Q.23 **(A)** | Q.24 **(D)** | Q.25 **(C)** | |

## Explanations

### English Language

**Q.1 · Answer (D) The driving test was passed quite easily by Aditya.**

The past simple 'passed' becomes 'was passed', with 'the driving test' as the subject: 'The driving test was passed quite easily by Aditya.'

**Q.2 · Answer (D) not do a thing well in order to save money or effort**

To 'cut corners' is to do something in the easiest or cheapest way, at the cost of quality.

**Q.3 · Answer (A) To falsify financial records**

To 'cook the books' is to falsify a company's accounts.

**Q.4 · Answer (B) than hospitalise**

'Than' compares 'home isolation' with another noun, so it needs 'hospitalisation', not the verb 'hospitalise'.

**Q.5 · Answer (A) Sometimes the family likes**

A singular subject in the present simple takes a finite verb ending in -s: 'Sometimes the family likes to play a game together'. 'Sometime' means at some unstated time.

**Q.6 · Answer (C) consequences**

The 'consequences' of a decision are its results, which one should think about before taking it.

**Q.7 · Answer (C) CBDA**

C tells of the storm uprooting trees, B singles out one of the fallen trees, D describes its ripped trunk and A the grass on either side of the trunk: CBDA.

**Q.8 · Answer (B) Suspicious**

'Paranoid' means unreasonably distrustful of others: 'suspicious'.

**Q.9 · Answer (D) Persistance**

The correct spelling is 'persistence'.

**Q.10 · Answer (C) omnipotent**

'Omnipotent' means all-powerful; 'omnipresent' means present everywhere.

**Q.11 · Answer (B) appeared**

The headmaster 'appeared', that is came into view, on the stage before he spoke.

**Q.12 · Answer (C) cowardice**

The opposite of 'bravery' is 'cowardice'; heroism, strength and courage are close to synonyms.

**Q.13 · Answer (B) complete**

'Absolute' means total, without any limit: 'complete'.

**Q.14 · Answer (B) Honest**

'Clandestine' means done in secret, usually because it is improper; of these, 'honest', open and above-board, is its opposite.

**Q.15 · Answer (B) Anchor**

An anchor presents a radio or television programme and links its parts.

**Q.16 · Answer (B) Had you not interfered**

A third conditional with the 'if' left out puts 'had' first and takes the past participle: 'Had you not interfered in my affairs, I would have been ...'

**Q.17 · Answer (A) BDCA**

B introduces Picasso and his father, a professor of drawing; D says he became his father's pupil at about 10; C, 'from that point', says he soon surpassed his father; and A tells how his father then shifted his ambitions to his son: BDCA.

**Q.18 · Answer (C) No error**
The sentence is correct: 'for both sides to introspect and re-examine ... and resolve it', with the verbs in parallel after 'to'.

**Q.20 · Answer (A) My niece told me that she had decided to take coaching in badminton.**
In reported speech the present perfect 'have decided' moves back to the past perfect 'had decided', and 'I' becomes 'she'.

**Q.21 · Answer (A) amount**
Rain is measured as a quantity, so 'the highest amount of summer rains'; 'number' counts separate things.

**Q.22 · Answer (B) making**
A participle phrase gives the result of the clause before it: '..., making it one of the very few places'.

**Q.23 · Answer (B) places**
'One of' takes a plural noun: 'one of the very few places in India'.

**Q.24 · Answer (D) distinct**
The rain is well distributed through the year, so there is 'no distinct', clearly marked, dry season.

**Q.25 · Answer (B) primary**
The rainfall is 'the primary reason', the main one, for the high yield of latex.

### General Intelligence

**Q.1 · Answer (D) 36 : 66 : 126**
Each number is twice the one before it minus 6: 28 × 2 – 6 = 50 and 50 × 2 – 6 = 94. Likewise 36 × 2 – 6 = 66 and 66 × 2 – 6 = 126.

**Q.2 · Answer (D) 17**
Each number appears twice and then rises by 3: 8, 8, 11, 11, 14, 14, 17.

**Q.4 · Answer (D) Neither conclusion I nor II follows.**
All rats are inside the cats, and some cats are outside the dogs, but nothing fixes how dogs and rats overlap. All dogs may be rats, or none may be, so neither conclusion must follow.

**Q.5 · Answer (A) Hockey : Coach**
A teacher teaches mathematics, as a coach trains players in hockey: the subject and the one who teaches it.

**Q.7 · Answer (A) r, t, s, m, r**
With r, t, s, m, r in the blanks the block srtm repeats: srtm srtm srtm srtm.

**Q.9 · Answer (C) Nickel**
Steel, brass and bronze are alloys; nickel is a metallic element.

**Q.10 · Answer (A) ₹180**
20 pens and 48 pencils are 4 times 5 pens and 12 pencils, so they cost 4 × ₹45 = ₹180.

**Q.11 · Answer (B) (601, 9401, 71427)**
The digits of the three numbers add up to 7, 14 and 21: 3 + 1 + 3, 2 + 7 + 3 + 2 and 9 + 8 + 2 + 1 + 1. Likewise 6 + 0 + 1 = 7, 9 + 4 + 0 + 1 = 14 and 7 + 1 + 4 + 2 + 7 = 21.

**Q.12 · Answer (B) 701**
The digits of 423, 171, 801 and 900 add up to 9, so each is divisible by 9. The digits of 701 add up to 8.

**Q.14 · Answer (A) YTSR**
In AEKM, IMPV and JMSU each letter comes later in the alphabet than the one before it. YTSR runs backwards.

**Q.15 · Answer (A) 640**
The second number is 2.5 times the first: 166 × 2.5 = 415. Likewise 256 × 2.5 = 640.

**Q.17 · Answer (D) Son-in-law**
M's wife is N's daughter-in-law, so M is N's son. O, M's sister, is N's daughter, and P, her husband, is N's son-in-law.

**Q.18 · Answer (C) 351114**
The code lists the alphabet positions of the letters in ascending order: ORGAN = 15, 18, 7, 1, 14 → 1 7 14 15 18. NECK = 14, 5, 3, 11 → 3 5 11 14: 351114.

**Q.19 · Answer (C) EEFHIOSUW**
The letters are rearranged in alphabetical order: HUSBAND → ABDHNSU, so HOUSEWIFE → EEFHIOSUW.

**Q.21 · Answer (B) 5 and 8; – and ÷**
Interchanging 5 and 8, and – and ÷: 78 ÷ 13 + 19 × 5 – 8 = 6 + 95 – 8 = 93.

**Q.22 · Answer (D) LAWGNIK**
The first three letters are reversed, then the last four: SHO RTLY → OHS YLTR. So WAL KING → LAW GNIK: LAWGNIK.

**Q.23 · Answer (C) Sedentary**
'Sleepless' means wakeful; 'sedentary' means spent sitting down.

**Q.24 · Answer (D) 5, 3, 1, 4, 2**
From the top of the hierarchy down: Owner (5), General manager (3), Manager (1), Supervisor (4), Worker (2).

### General Awareness

**Q.1 · Answer (D) 1907**
Ugyen Wangchuck was crowned the first hereditary king (Druk Gyalpo) of Bhutan on 17 December 1907.

**Q.2 · Answer (C) Hasan Raza**
Pakistan's Hasan Raza made his Test debut against Zimbabwe at Faisalabad in October 1996, aged 14 years and 227 days by his recorded date of birth, though that date was later doubted.

**Q.3 · Answer (C) Madhya Pradesh**
The Madhya Pradesh cabinet approved the Madhya Pradesh Freedom of Religion Bill 2020, against unlawful religious conversion, in December 2020.

**Q.4 · Answer (D) 1947 - 1971**
Bangladesh was East Pakistan from Partition in 1947 until it won independence in 1971.

**Q.5 · Answer (C) Banihal**
The Banihal pass, on the road from Jammu to Srinagar, crosses the Pir Panjal range. Zoji La lies on the Great Himalaya, Fotu La on the Zaskar and Khardung La on the Ladakh range.

**Q.6 · Answer (D) Random-access memory**
RAM is the computer's primary (main) memory, which the processor works from directly; hard disks, compact disks and pen drives are secondary storage.

**Q.8 · Answer (B) Atlanta Olympics**
Shabana Akhtar, a long jumper, competed at the 1996 Atlanta Olympics, the first woman to represent Pakistan at the Games.

**Q.9 · Answer (D) 1855-56**
The Santhal Hul, led by Sidhu and Kanhu Murmu, broke out in 1855 and was suppressed in 1856.

**Q.10 · Answer (D) Harsh Vardhan**
Dr Harsh Vardhan, then Union Health Minister, became Chairman of the WHO Executive Board in May 2020.

**Q.11 · Answer (D) Manisha Moun**
Manisha Moun won the 57 kg gold at the Cologne Boxing World Cup in December 2020, beating Sakshi Choudhary in an all-Indian final.

**Q.12 · Answer (B) Mizoram**
The Puanchei, a colourful hand-woven wrap-around skirt, is the traditional dress of Mizo women.

**Q.13 · Answer (C) John Maynard Keynes**
Using government spending and taxation to manage demand rests on John Maynard Keynes's 'General Theory' (1936).

**Q.14 · Answer (C) Myanmar Kyat**
Myanmar's currency is the kyat. The riel is Cambodia's, the dong Vietnam's and the ringgit Malaysia's.

**Q.15 · Answer (D) Disproportionation reaction**
In alkali, chlorine is both oxidised, to hypochlorite (the bleaching agent), and reduced, to chloride: $Cl_2 + 2OH^- \rightarrow ClO^- + Cl^- + H_2O$. An element oxidised and reduced in the same reaction is disproportionating; phosphorus and sulphur react in alkali in the same way.

**Q.17 · Answer (A) Pakistan**
SSC's key gives Pakistan, the only one of these countries the Safed Koh (Spin Ghar) reaches: the range runs about 160 km from the Peshawar valley in Pakistan west to the Logar valley in Afghanistan, forming a natural border between the two.

**Q.18 · Answer (D) Marmagao**
Marmagao in Goa is a natural harbour on the west coast. Visakhapatnam is also a natural harbour, but on the east coast, where Haldia (a riverine port) and Chennai (an artificial harbour) lie too.

**Q.19 · Answer (A) 21 May**
The UN General Assembly declared 21 May International Tea Day; it was first observed in 2020.

**Q.20 · Answer (D) Water**
Water's bent molecule leaves its bond dipoles uncancelled, so it is polar. The symmetrical shapes of carbon tetrachloride, carbon dioxide and benzene cancel any bond dipoles.

**Q.21 · Answer (A) Looks dull**
Metals are lustrous (shiny), not dull; they are also malleable, ductile and good conductors of heat.

**Q.22 · Answer (C) Ishtiaq Ahmed**
'Jinnah: His Successes, Failures and Role in History' (2020) is by the political scientist Ishtiaq Ahmed.

**Q.23 · Answer (A) Patiala Gharana**
Ustad Bade Ghulam Ali Khan was the leading singer of the Patiala gharana.

**Q.24 · Answer (D) Creeper**
Creeper (1971), which spread over ARPANET, is regarded as the first computer virus. Penguin and Panda are Google search updates, and a spider is a web crawler.

**Q.25 · Answer (C) Manipur**
Manipur held elections under universal adult franchise in 1948, under its Constitution Act of 1947, before independent India's first general election of 1951-52.

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